

Week 7 / Tuesday

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What is a Genre?

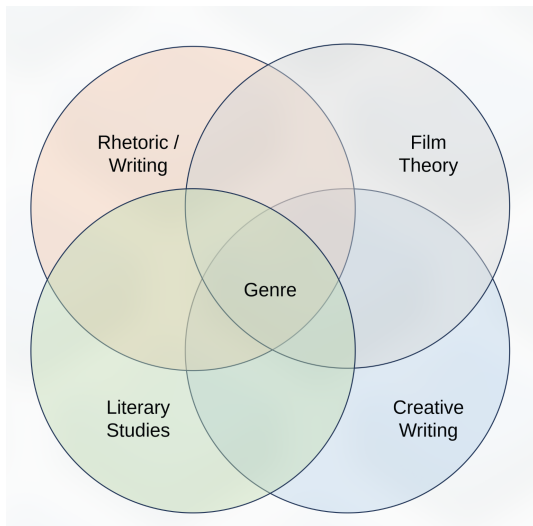


Figure: Genre intersects several areas of thought.

What is a Genre?

A name for a typical or repeated response to a situation.

Genre Conventions

- ▶ Content
- ▶ Design/structure
- ▶ Rhetorical strategies
- ▶ Organization of ideas
- ▶ Etc.

Examples of Genre Conventions

Rhetorical analysis essays:

- ▶ Thesis statements
- ▶ A text to analyze
- ▶ Academic formatting expectations (MLA/APA)
- ▶ Typical structures (intro/body/conclusion)

Examples of Genre Conventions

An email:

- ▶ A clear subject line.
- ▶ A salutation, body text.
- ▶ A closing.

Examples of Genre Conventions

An action film:

- ▶ Chase sequences.
- ▶ Fights.
- ▶ Explosions.

Examples of Genre Conventions

Trap music:

- ▶ Complicated hihat patterns.
- ▶ 808 sub basses.
- ▶ Typical themes in lyrical content.

Why are Genre Conventions Helpful?

Genres are useful by presenting information in a format that matches the expectations of audiences.

Genres and their Conventions Support Rhetorical Purposes

Rhetorical Analysis

Convention	Purpose
Thesis statement	Identifying the intellectual argument.
Focal text	Showing engagement with existing knowledge.
MLA-style formatting	Demonstrating your knowledge of academic writing norms.

Genres and their Conventions Support Rhetorical Purposes

Action Films

Conventions	Purpose
Chase sequences	Putting the audience in the place of a thrilling scene .
Fights	Showing culturally situated values of strength and athleticism.
Explosions	Audiences like when movie goes boom.

Genre Thinking: Writers/Composers

- ▶ General organizational patterns.
- ▶ Resources to begin a project.
- ▶ Understanding how to meet audience expectations.
- ▶ Rhetorical success.

Genre Thinking: Audiences

- ▶ Audience comprehension.
- ▶ Audience efficiency (e.g., the organization of a formal report is organized so that readers can read different sections).
- ▶ Rhetorical success.

Genres are not Just Patterns

They are a "bundle" of conventions and audience expectations that are adapted and broken when necessary.